# Introduction

"Our tests are broken again!" "Why does the suite take so long to run?" "What value are we getting from these tests anyway?"

The years go by and the technologies change, but the complaints about automated tests are the same. Teams try to improve the code and end up fighting test failures. Slow test times drag down productivity. Poorly written tests do a bad job communicating, guiding the software design, or catching bugs.

No matter whether you're new to automated tests or have been using them for years, this book will help you write more effective tests. By *effective*, we mean tests that give you more value than the time spent writing them.

We'll be using the RSpec 3 framework to explore the art of writing tests. Every aspect of RSpec was designed to solve some problem that developers have encountered in the wild. With it, you can build Ruby apps with confidence.

## How to Use This Book

With this book, you'll learn RSpec 3 in three phases:

- Part I: Introductory exercises to get you acquainted with RSpec
- Part II: A worked example spanning several chapters, so that you can see RSpec in action on a meaningfully sized project
- Parts III–V: A series of deep dives into specific aspects of RSpec, which will help you get the most out of RSpec

We wrote this book to be read cover to cover. Whatever your level of expertise, reading the chapters in order will give you the most value. However, if you're pressed for time and want to know where to look first, we can make a few suggestions.

If you're familiar with other test frameworks but new to RSpec, we recommend that you read the first two parts of the book, and then try RSpec out in one